

6. This extract informs us that

- (A) the amount of oxytocin given will depend on how the patient reacts.
- (B) the patient will go into labour as soon as oxytocin is administered.
- (C) the staff should inspect the oxytocin pump before use.

Extract from guidelines: Oxytocin

1 Oxytocin Dosage and Administration

Parenteral drug products should be inspected visually for particulate matter and discoloration prior to administration, whenever solution and container permit. Dosage of Oxytocin is determined by the uterine response. The dosage information below is based upon various regimens and indications in general use.

1.1 Induction or Stimulation of Labour

Intravenous infusion (drip method) is the only acceptable method of administration for the induction or stimulation of labour. Accurate control of the rate of infusion flow is essential. An infusion pump or other such device and frequent monitoring of strength of contractions and foetal heart rate are necessary for the safe administration of Oxytocin for the induction or stimulation of labour. If uterine contractions become too powerful, the infusion can be abruptly stopped, and oxytocic stimulation of the uterine musculature will soon wane.